

Chapter 175-3

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Zhao Xuning was truly crazy this time.

With a fever and cold, she knelt her way up the three thousand steps, and then got caught in the rain afterward.

By the time they went down the mountain, she already had a high fever and was sent directly to the hospital.

Everyone was worried sick the entire night, but she turned out to be fine. It was just that her two legs were badly damaged, her knees red, swollen, and bruised purple.

Shen Hui wasn't much better off either.

When they were sending Zhao Xuning to the hospital, she too nearly fainted from exhaustion.

However, Shen Fenghe didn't stop them this time. She directly let Shen Hui stay at the same hospital as Zhao Xuning.

They were busy rushing around until past four in the morning before it ended. When Liang Shi returned home, even though she was very quiet, she still woke Xu Qingzhu.

To be precise, Xu Qingzhu had been in a half-asleep state the whole time. When she sensed Liang Shi's return, she turned over, reached out to turn on the bedside lamp, and asked softly: "How is Dr. Zhao?"

"Nothing serious." Liang Shi slipped under the covers and reached out to hold her hand, which was still cool.

Xu Qingzhu rolled into her arms naturally. Liang Shi kissed her forehead lightly and patted her back. "Sleep peacefully."

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu yawned. In her arms, her sense of security multiplied. Drowsiness washed over her, and she quickly fell asleep.

Liang Shi turned off the bedside lamp, and the bedroom fell into darkness.

But she couldn't fall asleep no matter what.

The image of Zhao Xuning kneeling her way up the three thousand steps seemed carved into her mind.

In the past, she had acted in similar scenes.

In dramas, she had performed well enough, with enough empathy.

But it was nothing compared to today.

That was a kind of shock.

Watching Zhao Xuning's back made her heart unable to calm down. The surging emotions eventually transformed into sighs of lament.

She didn't know how much time had passed before she finally understood in her daze.

It was because Zhao Xuning was too resolute.

That kind of determination from the heart made people empathize.

Liang Shi's sympathy for Zhao Xuning increased just a little bit more.

Even though she slept late, Liang Shi didn't sleep in. She woke up naturally very early.

Xu Qingzhu had been awake for a while but stayed nestled in her arms without moving.

The moment Liang Shi opened her eyes, she saw Xu Qingzhu staring at her intently. Liang Shi was dazed for a moment, then curved her lips into a light smile, her voice low: "Good morning, baby."

"Morning~" Xu Qingzhu squinted her eyes and nuzzled further into her arms like a cat.

"Is Dr. Zhao awake yet?" Xu Qingzhu asked. "Should we go see her today~"

Liang Shi said: "I'll make some soup later and bring it to her. We'll just stay for a bit."

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "Okay."

While Liang Shi was making soup, Xu Qingzhu was also in the kitchen helping, though there wasn't really anything to do—she just wandered around the kitchen.

Xu Qingzhu asked if she couldn't sleep.

Liang Shi nodded.

"Yesterday's hot search was taken down very quickly," Xu Qingzhu said. "After that, no one discussed it anymore."

"The Zhao family had it removed," Liang Shi said. "Zhao Xuning's mother went there yesterday, and so did the Shen family. Shen Siyan really impressed me."

"Oh?" Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow.

Liang Shi recalled the scene from yesterday and briefly told her about it.

"Zhao Ling used to say Shen Siyan has a sister complex," Liang Shi smiled lightly. "Now I can see it."

"That's quite nice. I used to think families like the Shen family and the Gu family would have strict family traditions, like Dr. Zhao's family." Xu Qingzhu said. "I didn't expect them to be pretty good. They seem quite harmonious."

Liang Shi nodded: "Now those two shouldn't have to torment each other anymore."

"If they keep tormenting each other, they'll just drop dead on the spot." Xu Qingzhu shared a comment she saw yesterday. "A netizen said: I just wanted to date you, but you wanted to go to hell with me."

"Tormenting each other until their hair turns white." Liang Shi was helpless too. "I hope they can find happiness together."

"If only Dr. Zhao wasn't so reserved," Xu Qingzhu said. "She's a very direct person, but when it comes to feelings, she's not that kind of direct."

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment before summarizing: "She's very straightforward with people she doesn't like, but becomes all awkward with people she likes."

"Right." Liang Shi said. "She also doesn't know how to communicate properly. When I was staying at her place before—something that could easily be discussed, she had to beat around the bush. She'd actually still help you with things, but her words would be unforgiving."

Xu Qingzhu hugged Liang Shi from behind. "So I still like you more."

Liang Shi's hand holding the ladle paused. "I'm not that great either."

"Then maybe I'm blind?" Xu Qingzhu's voice rose at the end.

"Well, not exactly." Liang Shi said. "Yesterday when Zhao Xuning was kneeling her way up the three thousand steps, I was thinking—if one day we ended up like that, would I do the same thing?"

Xu Qingzhu asked: "Did you come up with an answer?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "No."

Without being pushed to that point, saying whether you would or wouldn't do it would be false.

Liang Shi put the ladle down on the counter and turned to hug Xu Qingzhu: "I've decided I'll just keep loving you well. No matter how you try to push me away, I won't leave. I'll tell you everything. Then I won't need to kneel my way up three thousand steps."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"You left secretly before though." Xu Qingzhu exposed her.

Liang Shi felt like an arrow had struck her heart and immediately explained: "I had no choice back then."

"Who in this world doesn't have moments when they have no choice?" Xu Qingzhu had thought it through clearly. "People in love separate because they have no choice—for the sake of pride, for the other person's good, sometimes wanting to escape, worldly pressure, financial pressure. Every day, people in love face different circumstances where they have no choice. But people still fall in love. Why is that?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"I can't out-argue you." Liang Shi said helplessly. "I surrender. That was indeed my mistake. I accept my punishment."

Xu Qingzhu looked up at her and bit her neck lightly. "Mm, I'll have to punish you for a long time."

"But why is that?" Liang Shi asked again. "So many people have no choice, yet they still continue to love each other. Why?"

Xu Qingzhu exhaled softly, her fingers sliding down to interlock with Liang Shi's. "Why are you with me?"

Liang Shi thought about it before answering: "Happiness. When I see you, I feel like my whole heart is filled."

That feeling of contentment was completely different from going shopping and buying things, or eating amazing food, or seeing beautiful scenery.

A heart that felt tingly and numb, warm and full.

In the twenty-four hours of a day, there was always a moment when you could feel your heart beating beautifully and passionately.

That seemed like the meaning of being alive.

Even when things outside were hard and tiring, when difficult things happened.

But just thinking that there was such a person made everything seem like nothing.

There was always motivation to keep going.

Creating bonds. Bonds bring joy.

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "So you see, people fall in love to fill their hearts."